

Advertisement

SECURITY



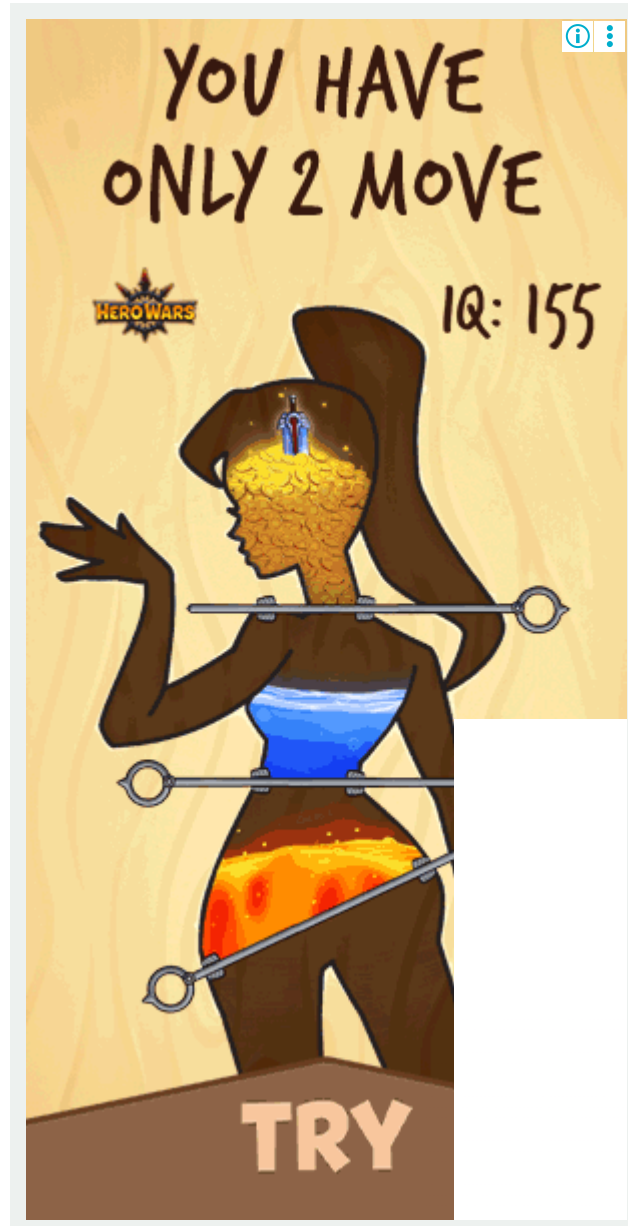
Hackers breach and expose a major North Korean spying operation

Hackers claim to have compromised the computer of a North Korean government hacker and leaked its contents online, offering a rare window into a hacking operation by the notoriously secretive nation.

The two hackers, who go by Saber and cyb0rg, published a report about the breach in the latest issue of *Phrack* magazine, a legendary cybersecurity e-zine that was first published in 1985. The latest issue was distributed at the Def Con hackers conference in Las Vegas last week.

In the article, the two hackers wrote that they were able to compromise a workstation containing a virtual machine and a virtual private server belonging to the hacker, whom they call “Kim.” The hackers claim Kim works for the North Korean government espionage group known as Kimsuky, also known as APT43 and Thallium. The hackers leaked the stolen data to DDoSecrets, a nonprofit collective that stores leaked datasets in the public interest.

Kimsuky is a prolific advanced persistent threat (APT) group widely believed to be working inside North Korea’s government, targeting journalists and government agencies in South Korea and elsewhere, and other targets that could be of interest for North Korea’s intelligence apparatus.



DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

As is usual with North Korea, Kimsuky also conducts operations more akin to a cybercriminal group — for example, [stealing and laundering cryptocurrencies](#) to fund North Korea’s nuclear weapons program.

This hack gives an almost-unprecedented look inside the operation of Kimsuky, given that the two hackers compromised one of the group’s members, rather than investigating a data breach as cybersecurity researchers and companies typically have to rely on.

“It shows a glimpse how openly ‘Kimsuky’ cooperates with Chinese [government hackers] and shares their tools and techniques,” the hackers wrote.



AN ILLUSTRATION OF NORTH KOREAN DICTATOR KIM JONG-UN, WHICH WAS INCLUDED IN THE PHRACK ARTICLE.

IMAGE CREDITS: SABER AND CYBØRG/PHRACK

Obviously, what Saber and cybOrg did is technically a crime, although they will likely never be prosecuted for it, considering North Korea is [sanctioned up to its eyeballs](#). The two hackers clearly believe Kimsuky members deserve to be exposed and embarrassed.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- [HR giant Workday says hackers stole personal data in recent breach](#)
- [How your solar rooftop became a national security issue](#)
- [A comprehensive list of 2025 tech layoffs](#)
- [Co-founder of Elon Musk’s xAI departs the company](#)
- [Google CEO adds a new calendar feature at Stripe co-founder’s request](#)
- [NASA has sparked a race to develop the data pipeline to Mars](#)
- [Why I finally left Spotify](#)

“Kimsuky, you’re not a hacker. You are driven by financial greed, to enrich your leaders, and to fulfill their political agenda. You steal from others and favour your own. You value yourself above the others: You are morally perverted,” the two wrote in Phrack. “You hack for all the wrong reasons.”

Saber and cyb0rg claim to have found evidence of Kimsuky compromising several South Korean government networks and companies, email addresses, and hacking tools used by the Kimsuky group, internal manuals, passwords, and more data.

Emails sent to the addresses allegedly belonging to the hackers, which were listed in the research, went unanswered.

The hackers wrote that they were able to identify Kim as a North Korean government hacker, thanks to “artifacts and hints” that pointed in that direction, including files configurations and domains previously attributed to the North Korean hacking group Kimsuky.

The hackers also noted Kim’s “strict office hours, always connecting at around 09:00 and disconnecting by 17:00 Pyongyang time.”

Topics: [cybercrime](#) [cybersecurity](#) [DEF CON](#)

[Def Con 2025](#) [DPRK](#) [hackers](#) [hacking](#)

[North Korea](#) [Phrack](#) [Security](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [📷](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

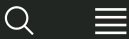
Senior Reporter, Cybersecurity | [X](#) [🦋](#) [@](#)

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai is a Senior Writer at TechCrunch, where he covers hacking, cybersecurity,...

View Bio >

KEEP READING

- Latest
- Security
- Startups
- AI
- Venture
- Apps
- Apple



- Events
- Podcasts
- Newsletters

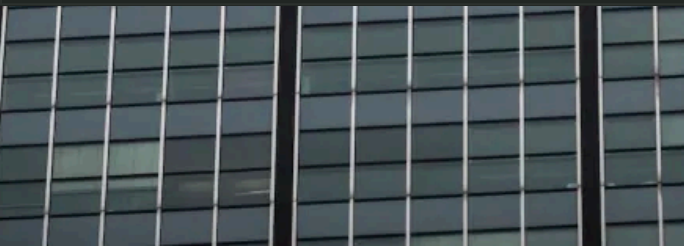


IMAGE CREDITS:
BILDQUELLE/ULLSTEIN BILD / GETTY IMAGES

Zack Whittaker — 3:26 PM PDT · August 18, 2025

The July data breach at U.S. insurance giant Allianz Life allowed hackers to steal the personal information of 1.1 million customers, according to data breach notification site Have I Been Pwned.

Allianz Life disclosed the data breach in late July, confirming that hackers stole the personal

Newsletters [See More ↗](#)

Subscribe for the industry’s biggest tech news

information of [the “majority” of its 1.4 million customers](#) and its employees from a cloud-stored customer relationship database. Allianz has so far refused to confirm exactly how many people are affected by the breach.

Have I Been Pwned, a [data breach notification site](#) that alerts people when their email address has been caught up in data breaches, said [in a post on Monday](#) the Allianz Life breach includes customers’ names, gender, date of birth, email and home addresses, and phone numbers from a database hosted by cloud giant Salesforce.

Allianz Life later told the states of Texas and Massachusetts the hackers also [stole Social Security numbers](#) in the breach.

Brett Weinberg, a spokesperson for Allianz Life, declined to comment to TechCrunch as the company’s investigation is ongoing.

Allianz Life is one of a series of tech and corporate giants that have been targeted in recent months by a hacking crew known as ShinyHunters, a group known for their social engineering skills aimed at tricking employees into granting them access to the company’s databases.

[Google](#), [Cisco](#), [airline giant Qantas](#), and [retailer Pandora](#) — and also [HR giant Workday, as reported by TechCrunch on Monday](#) — have also reported recent data thefts related to their Salesforce-hosted data.

The ShinyHunters gang is said to be preparing a data leak site in an attempt to extort victims into paying the hackers to delete the data, a tactic often employed by ransomware gangs. The group reportedly overlaps with other hacking and crime groups, [including Scattered Spider](#) and [The Com](#), a known collective of cybercriminals who use

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch’s coverage.

Startups Weekly



Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review



Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility



TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

No newsletters selected.

Email address

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).



hacking, extortion, and sometimes threats of violence to break into networks.

We're always looking to evolve, and by providing some insight into your perspective and feedback into TechCrunch and our coverage and events, you can help us! Fill out [this survey](#) to let us know how we're doing and get the chance to win a prize in return!

Topics: [allianz life](#) [cybersecurity](#) [insurance](#) [Security](#)



Zack Whittaker

Security Editor |

Zack Whittaker is the security editor at TechCrunch. He can be reached via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337...](#)

[View Bio](#) >

———— KEEP READING ————

SECURITY



HR giant Workday says hackers stole personal data in recent breach



Workday, one of the largest providers of human resources technology, has confirmed a data breach that allowed hackers to steal personal information from one of its third-party customer relationship databases.

In [a blog post published late Friday](#), the HR technology giant said the hackers stole an unspecified amount of personal information from the database, which Workday said was primarily used to store contact information, such as names, email addresses, and phone numbers.

IMAGE CREDITS:

SMITH COLLECTION/GADO / GETTY IMAGES

Workday did not explicitly rule out that customer information was taken in the data breach, stating only that there was “no indication of access to customer tenants or the data within them,” which corporate customers typically use to store the bulk of their human resources files and employees’ personal data.

The company said the stolen information may be used to further social engineering scams, where hackers trick or threaten victims into giving them access to sensitive data.

Workday has more than 11,000 corporate customers, serving at least 70 million users around the world, [per the company’s website](#). Bleeping

Latest in Security

[See More](#)

SECURITY



US spy chief says UK has dropped its Apple backdoor demand

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

- 51 minutes ago

SECURITY



Allianz Life data breach affects 1.1 million customers

Zack Whittaker - 17 hours ago

SECURITY



HR giant Workday says hackers stole personal data in recent breach

Zack Whittaker - 1 day ago

Computer [reports](#) that the hack was discovered on August 6.

Workday did not identify the breached third-party customer database platform, but follows in a recent spate of cyberattacks targeting Salesforce-hosted databases used by large companies to store customer data. In recent weeks, [Google](#), [Cisco](#), [airline giant Qantas](#), and [retailer Pandora](#) have all had reams of data stolen from their Salesforce databases.

Google attributed the breaches to ShinyHunters, a group of hackers known for using voice phishing to steal corporate data by tricking company employees into granting them access to their cloud-based databases. Google said ShinyHunters was likely in the process of preparing a data leak site to extort its victims into paying the hackers to delete the data, akin to how ransomware gangs operate.

Connor Spielmaker, a spokesperson for Workday, did not comment beyond Workday's blog post or answer TechCrunch's questions, including whether Workday knows how many individuals had data stolen or who the stolen data relates to, such as Workday employees or Workday's corporate customers. Workday would not say if it has the technical means, such as logs, to determine what customer data was exfiltrated.

As of the time of publication, Workday's blog post [disclosing the breach](#) contained a hidden "noindex" tag in its source code, which instructs search engines to ignore the page, making it difficult for anyone searching the web to find the page.

It's not clear for what reason Workday is hiding its data breach notification from search engines.

Do you know more about the Workday data breach or attacks targeting Salesforce databases? Have

you been notified about a data breach? Securely contact this reporter via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337](#) on Signal.

Updated with a response from Workday.

We're always looking to evolve, and by providing some insight into your perspective and feedback into TechCrunch and our coverage and events, you can help us! Fill out [this survey](#) to let us know how we're doing and get the chance to win a prize in return!

Topics: [cyberattack](#) [cybersecurity](#) [data breach](#)

[human resources](#) [Salesforce](#) [Security](#)

[Workday](#)



Zack Whittaker

Security Editor |

Zack Whittaker is the security editor at TechCrunch. He can be reached via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337...](#)

[View Bio](#) >

Loading the next article



[TechCrunch](#)

[Staff](#)

[Contact Us](#)

[Advertise](#)

[Crunchboard
Jobs](#)

[Terms of
Service](#)

[Privacy
Policy](#)

[RSS Terms of
Use](#)

[Neuralink](#)

[Google Chrome](#)

[StubHub](#)

[Claude](#)

[GPT-5](#)

[Tech Layoffs](#)

